The Truth About Being a Girl – A Collection

By Lina Banzaca and Aija Mayrock

Dear, Girl by Aija Mayrock

(Pg 3) Dear Girl,

You ask me what I wish for you.

I simply say --

never allow any soul to clip your wings

you were not born an ember,

you were born the flame.

(Pg 7) Dear Everyone,

Grab ahold of your voice.

It is time to make a choice

to believe survivors

to pay us all the same

to give women of color equal access and opportunity

to protect the safety of trans girls every day.

Make the choice to change the climate,

make the choice to not stay silent.

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This is not the era of girls.

This is the future of girls.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Aija Mayrock
Book: Dear Girl, pg 3,7
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Date (Month/Year): Aug 2020

INTRODUCTION

The Truth About Being a Girl – A Collection by Lina Banzaca and Aija Mayrock

Dress Code by Lina Banzaca

It's before first-period . . .

My teachers see me walking down the hallway and rudely gawk at my body as if it's some sort of disgrace.

Flash forward . . .

My teacher calls the assistant principal down to 'approve' my clothes.

I'm sent to the office to find out my mother was on her way.

The same mother who has to work every day to make a living, and to pay for my clothes.

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The same mother who's making eighty-one cents to my principal's dollar.
The same mother who taught me to love my body and how to look appropriate.
The same mother who approved and complimented me, only an hour before, earlier that morning.

The bell for the second period rings.
I'm still sitting in the office.
Because wasting my time over what I'm wearing is more important than my education. Right?
I can hear the whispers of my degrading school's staff.
A few higher established adults to an 'outfit check'.
Quickly after, the assistant called my name.
I gulped down my fear and anxiety, as I stood up.
Then I'm sent into a room.
The dullest, dark, and grayest room I have ever entered.
"Hello Lina, we're gathered here to talk about your outfit today."
A tee shirt dress with shorts underneath.
It reminded me of when I was in the fifth grade.
Girls were told that we needed to cover ourselves up

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because boys thought about our bodies in a sexual manner, and if we dressed a certain way and something happened, it was our fault.

It's getting close to the third period when my mother arrives.
After the constant duel to what seemed, death, with words, I got to go.
I didn't have to change this time.
I was lucky.
Lucky that a teacher came to my defense along with my mother, and told them my outfit was fine, and I couldn't help that I was a curvier girl.
Instead of focusing on what girls are wearing, maybe we should tell boys to keep their hands to themselves and grow up.
Because that's what the girls have to learn from an early age.
Our bodies shouldn't be over sexualized for what's covering them.
Girls are body shamed and dress coded everywhere because of what we wear.

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What if we focused on teaching students to be mature
young adults, rather than disgusting pigs who apparently
can't handle a girl who shows her shoulders?
Let's all obsess over real world problems.
Not what someone wears, or if it's distracting to boys.
Just when someone starts having confidence
(which is a victory in itself),
we're torn down based off of the clothes we put on our
bodies.
Girls are taught that it's our fault.

Boys can just open and claim your body,
like some kind of book.
Even when the only word printed is NO.
We struggle in our bodies from such a young age.
Instead of worrying about a girl's apparel, let's worry about
the men who need to learn to control themselves.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Lina Banzaca
ISBN: On-Line Transcript
https://hellopoetry.com/poem/2031728/dress-code/
Publisher: Hello Poetry.com
Date (Month/Year): July 2017

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The Truth About Being a Girl by Aija Mayrock (Pg 34-39)

People always say that the girls of this generation are so
vain:
"Why can't they put their brains towards books instead of
good looks?"
I used to blame girls too: "Be more than a perfect body and
a pretty hairdo."
But then I stepped into the world
and opened my eyes to the truth about being a girl.

Don't blame me, but when I thought about boys,
I thought about dinner dates and soul mates,
not boys that look at you like shark bait.
It breaks my heart for every girl growing up in this world.

I am not an object.
I have a voice and something to say.
For anyone who thinks that this generation is so vain,
it's because we girls are held under a microscope day after
day.

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It's like “beautiful” doesn't even exist
unless you can cross everything off the checklist
big butt
big boobs
skinny waist
Includes:
small nose
plump lips

In all fairness,
I want to be seen as beautiful too.
I mean,
I don't want to be demeaned.
I am stuck in between
being a girl and a woman.
Growing up in a world
that has taught me to look sexy,
get a degree,
maybe a little rhinoplasty,
but never,
never
disagree with misogyny.

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A world that has taught me
that being a woman
means living in fear
that your basic health care
will disappear,
or
that your paycheck
might somehow be smaller
than a man
who does the same job,
or
that your boss will tell you to stop giving him
eyes
“If you want a raise, you gotta compromise.
Boy, please.
The moment you misidentified everything,
you forgot
that a hundred years ago
I could not vote.
Look at what happens
when you try to demote

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the very bodies
that give birth to you.
Please.
We are used to it all
and we are appalled
but, you see,
we don't know what it's like to be free.
***
Equality
is not just about
calling someone out.
Equality is accountability.
It is my brother knowing
that I am equal to him.
So equality
is education
from classrooms
and courtrooms,
to conference rooms
and computer screens.
Equality is truth,
is strong voices.

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It is breaking through the silence that exists,
because silence
can't exist
if it's not tolerated.
Equality is you
changing the future,
clearing the path
for every woman
and
every man.
It is raising the next generation to know
that not only
does their voice matter
but
it will be heard.

We have the power in our hands.
As we will not sit back
and nod
and smile
while certain people
reconcile

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the rules

of being fertile.

Sorry, but it's my body, baby.

I may be a young lady

but my father always taught me

to speak out

and fight

against injustice of every kind.

We will not stop

until we hold our rights

for women of every color

size

shape

sexual identity

and place

in this world.

And that is the truth about being a girl.

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AWARD HISTORY

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